



CHAMARI'S LANKA CREATES HISTORY IN DAMBULLA

Host Sri Lanka **handed India a reality check** with an eight-wicket victory in the final of the Women's Asia Cup, clinching its maiden title in the process.

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Last month, two fixtures between India and Sri Lanka were scheduled on July 28: one between the senior men's teams (the second fixture of a three-match bilateral series), and the other between the senior women's sides in the final of the Women's Asia Cup.

The former was a bilateral fixture in Kandy that took the 7 pm prime time slot for the benefit of television

audiences in the country while for the latter crowds in Dambulla were witness to two of the strongest sides in the continent.

Prime time or otherwise, the Women's Asia Cup put on a show for the hordes of fans assembled at the Rangiri Dambulla International Cricket Stadium and for those following the match broadcast, with Sri Lanka pulling off an upset for the ages, beating India by eight wickets to lift its maiden Asia Cup title. The long penance for the Asian crown had borne fruit on the nation's sixth

attempt.

For Chamari Athapaththu and Co., this win capped an incredible turn of fortune over the last couple of years that has seen the side match historically superior opponents toe-to-toe. But the biggest problem for this team was never its opponents; it was its own inexperience and tendency to retreat into a shell when things got rough.

Chamari, the leader of the pack, is one of the last remaining members of a generation of experienced players who have slowly made their